

A perfect PageSpeed score isn't magic — it's the result of a series of deliberate decisions. Here's the exact checklist I work through to get client sites to a green 100 on both mobile and desktop.

1. Ship less JavaScript

The single biggest cause of poor scores is too much JavaScript. Build with a framework like [Astro](#) that ships zero JS by default, and only add interactivity where it earns its place.

2. Optimise your images

Images are usually the heaviest thing on a page. Always:

- Serve modern formats (WebP or AVIF).
- Size images to their display dimensions — don't send a 4000px photo to a 400px slot.
- Add explicit `width` and `height` to prevent layout shift.
- Lazy-load anything below the fold.

3. Self-host and preload fonts

Web fonts can block rendering. Use `font-display: swap`, preconnect to the font host, and only load the weights you actually use.

4. Inline critical CSS

Astro can automatically inline small stylesheets so the browser doesn't need a second round trip before it can paint your page.

5. Cache aggressively at the edge

Hosting on Cloudflare means your pages are served from a data centre near your visitor, with long cache lifetimes on static assets. This is where a good host turns a fast build into a fast experience.

6. Measure, don't guess

Run [PageSpeed Insights](#) and [WebPageTest](#) on real pages. Fix the biggest offenders first, then re-measure.

Do all six and 100/100 stops being a lucky accident and becomes the baseline every one of your pages ships with.